

FORCING OF THE MISSISSIPPI FORTS

On April 24, 1862, Commodore Farragut of the United States Navy sent his West Gulf Blockading Squadron of nine gunboats, eight steamboats, and several mortar vessels up the Mississippi to wrest New Orleans from Confederate control. The city fell peacefully, but Farragut's squadron endured a vicious bombardment from the Confederate strongholds, forts Jackson (left) and St. Philip.